

PRIORITY TECH AREAS

(MUST KNOW PROPERLY)

1. Authentication & Authorization

(VERY IMPORTANT)

Almost every strong backend project needs this.

Must Know

- JWT
 - refresh tokens
 - access tokens
 - cookies vs localStorage
 - session management
 - RBAC (role-based access control)
 - OAuth basics
 - password hashing
 - authentication middleware
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Interview Questions

- Why JWT?
 - Why refresh tokens?
 - Why not store token in localStorage?
 - Difference between authentication and authorization?
 - How do sessions work?
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2. Real-Time Systems

(HUGE VALUE)

This immediately upgrades your projects.

Must Learn

- WebSockets
 - Socket.IO
 - event-driven architecture
 - real-time synchronization
 - rooms/channels
 - presence systems
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Build Features Like

- live reputation updates
 - collaborative editing
 - notifications
 - live submissions
 - activity tracking
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Interview Gold

Real-time systems are respected.

3. Database Design

(EXTREMELY IMPORTANT)

Most students are weak here.

Must Know

- schema design
- indexing

- normalization vs denormalization
 - relationships
 - aggregation
 - pagination
 - query optimization
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VERY Important

Understand:

WHY database design decisions are made.

Interview Questions

- Why MongoDB?
 - When is SQL better?
 - Why indexing improves performance?
 - What causes slow queries?
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4. Caching

(HUGE DIFFERENTIATOR)

This makes you look advanced.

Learn

- Redis basics
 - in-memory caching
 - cache invalidation
 - rate limiting
 - session caching
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Use Cases

- leaderboard caching
 - reputation caching
 - task feed caching
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Interview Impact

Very high.

Because scaling discussions start here.

5. Async & Backend Architecture

(CRITICAL)

Most Node developers remain shallow here.

Must Understand

- event loop
 - async/await
 - promises
 - non-blocking I/O
 - queues
 - background jobs
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Build

- email queues
 - async evaluation
 - delayed processing
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HUGE Interview Topic

The Node.js event loop.

MASTER this properly.

6. System Design Thinking

(MOST IMPORTANT)

Even for freshers.

Learn

- scalability basics
 - load balancing
 - bottlenecks
 - horizontal scaling
 - stateless systems
 - microservices basics
 - CDN basics
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Not Theory Only

Apply it in YOUR project.

Example

Instead of:

`single giant backend`

think:

- task service
- evaluation service
- notification service

Even if simplified.

7. File Storage & Upload Systems

(VERY useful)

Learn

- multer
 - cloud storage
 - chunk uploads
 - streaming
 - metadata storage
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Useful For

- project submissions
 - resume uploads
 - screenshots
 - evidence systems
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8. Security

(MASSIVE DIFFERENTIATOR)

Most students ignore this.

Must Know

- XSS
- CSRF
- rate limiting
- hashing

- input validation
 - SQL/NoSQL injection
 - CORS
 - helmet
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Build Security Properly

Interviewers LOVE this.

9. Docker

(VERY high value)

DO NOT go super deep initially.

But learn:

- containers
 - Dockerfiles
 - docker-compose
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Why Important

Deployment + sandboxing + scalability.

10. Deployment & DevOps Basics

(MUST)

Most students never deploy properly.

Learn

- VPS basics
 - reverse proxy
 - environment variables
 - CI/CD basics
 - domain setup
 - HTTPS
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Deploy EVERYTHING

A deployed project feels REAL.

11. AI Integration

(Optional but Powerful)

For your reputation platform:
VERY valuable.

Learn

- OpenAI APIs
 - embeddings basics
 - semantic similarity
 - AI evaluation systems
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Example Features

- explain code quality
 - detect shallow understanding
 - generate task variants
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12. Architecture & Code Quality

(VERY overlooked)

Learn

- modular backend architecture
 - clean folder structures
 - reusable services
 - middleware design
 - separation of concerns
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MOST IMPORTANT INTERVIEW SKILL

Be able to explain:

WHY you structured the system this way.

IMPORTANT Technologies To Revise DEEPLY

Your Core Stack

Tech	Depth Required
JavaScript	VERY deep
React	Deep
Next.js	Deep
Node.js	VERY deep
Express	Deep
MongoDB	Deep
Git	VERY deep

ADD THESE

Tech	Priority
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Tech	Priority
Redis	HIGH
Socket.IO	HIGH
Docker	HIGH
JWT/Auth	VERY HIGH
Deployment	VERY HIGH

MOST IMPORTANT CONCEPTS

If you master THESE,
you become strong.